

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 8 3 2

♥ J 9 7

♦ 10 6

♣ 8 7 3

♠ A K 6 5

♥ 8 3

♦ K J 7 3

♣ A K 5



♠ J 9

♥ Q 10 6 5

♦ Q 9 2

♣ J 10 9 4

♠ 7 4

♥ A K 4 2

♦ A 8 5 4

♣ Q 6 2

West	North	East	South
	1♦	Pass	1♥
Pass	1♠	Pass	3♦
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♥
Pass	6♦		
All Pass			

6♦ by North

Lead: ♣J

The 4♣ and 4♥ bids were control-showing. North is to play 6♦. East leads the ♣J.

Losers: ♠=2 ♥=0 ♦=2 ♣=0 Total = 4

That loser count may be technically correct but actually it's wonky. As long as ♦s split 3-2 like they should you only have 1 loser in the suit. And if West has the ♦Q you can finesse and have no losers. Also, those 2 ♠ losers could be ruffed in dummy.

Suppose you tried it like this: Win the ♣, play ♦A, then a ♦ to the ♦J, then pull the last trump with your ♦K. That would only leave one trump in dummy for ruffing ♠ losers, but you could make the slam.

But suppose the ♦ finesse lost to East. And further suppose that East then played another ♦. Since only 1 ♠ could be ruffed you'd be down 1. Try something else.

You win the ♣ and cash the ♦A. Dummy leads the ♦4 and West plays low.

Win the ♣. Play the ♦A and ♦K, forgetting about even trying the finesse. If the ♦Q falls that's good, but if it doesn't, no problem, just leave it out there. Then start on your other high cards. Take 2 more ♣s, 2 ♠s, and 2 ♥s. Then start cross-ruffing the last 4 ♠s and ♥s. The ♦Q guy can trump in whenever he likes but you will make 12 tricks.

This is the complete deal.

again to see what would have happened if you had finessed in trumps.

Suppose you had won the first ♣, then played ♦A and lost the ♦ finesse to East's ♦Q. East might have then played his last trump back to your ♦J and the hands would look like this.

You need the rest of the tricks but the best you can do now is to take the two high ♣s, the two high ♥s, the two high ♠s, one ♥ ruff in your hand and one ♠ ruff in dummy. Letting East pull that third round of trumps did you in.

This is how it would have looked if you had won the first ♣ trick, then just played the ♦A and ♦K, not trying the trump finesse.

Leaving the master trump out, you would now proceed to take your two high ♣s, two high ♥s and two high ♠s.

Needing just three more tricks, and with two trumps in each hand you just cross-ruff ♥s and ♠. East can ruff in with the ♦Q at some point but he cannot prevent you from winning at least three of your trumps separately.

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 8 2
♥ K 6 5
♦ K 4 2
♣ Q J 7 4

♠ 6

♥ A 8 7 2

♦ Q J 9 7

♣ 10 8 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q 9 7 4

♥ 9 4

♦ A 6 5

♣ A K 6

♠ J 10 5 3

♥ Q J 10 3

♦ 10 8 3

♣ 9 3

West	North	East	South
1♣	Pass	1♠	Pass
1NT	Pass	2♦	Pass
2♠	Pass	4♠	

All Pass

4♠ by East

Lead: ♥Q

trick and on the ♥J continuation, hoping North started with a doubleton ♥A. But he didn't, and he plays it on the third ♥ which you ruff.

Back to the Plan. Having ruffed the ♥ you are down to just 4 trumps in your hand. You play ♠A, ♠K, ♠Q, noting that North discards on the second round. Therefore South will get a trump trick.

But don't give it to him now! Leave South with his master trump and switch to ♣s. If South doesn't ruff at all you will run 4 ♣ tricks and discard your ♦ loser. If he does decide to ruff it will be with a trick you were going to lose anyway. You win his return, ruffing a ♥ with the last trump, and continue playing ♣ and ♦ winners.

You can't help losing two ♥s and one ♠.

But you don't have to lose anything else as long as you don't lose trump control. So leave the master trump with South and just cash your minor suit winners. Let South ruff whenever he wants to because that will establish your ♠9 to control any more ♥ leads. If he decides not to ruff at all then he can have the final trick with his high trump.

East's 2♦ bid was New Minor Forcing, asking if West has 3 ♠s. West's 2♠ response said "Yes, I have." East is to play 4♠. South leads the ♥Q.

Losers: ♠ = ? ♥ = 2 ♦ = 1 ♣ = 0 Total = 3?

If the ♠s split 3-2 as they should, you have no ♠ loser and your plan will merely be to pull trumps and play winners. So what you do in that case is start figuring how to deal with a 4-1 split.

But first you should deal with the ♥K situation. Do you cover the ♥Q or not?

North plays the ♥2 and you the ♥4.

South continues with the ♥J.

Competent defenders do not underlead Aces at suit contracts. So if you are playing against a competent South you certainly don't cover. You play low on this

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 4
♥ J 9 5 2
♦ Q J 10 6 3
♣ 10 8 4

♠ 10 8
♥ K Q 8 6
♦ 8 7 2
♣ 9 7 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 7 6 2
♥ 10 7 4 3
♦ 9 5
♣ Q J 6

♠ A K Q 9 5 3
♥ A
♦ A K 4
♣ A K 2

West	North	East	South
			2 ♣
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	6 ♠
All Pass			

6 ♠ by South

Lead: ♦ Q

dummy. A defender will surely take his ♠ J here, and play another ♦. Win that trick and play another small ♠. This one will get you into dummy. And by the way, West discards a ♦ so it turns out you were going to lose a trump in any case. Play dummy's ♥ K Q, discarding your two minor losers. Ruff a ♥ to return to your hand, pull trumps and claim.

As you can see you have a trump loser in addition to the small ♦ and ♣. By establishing the ♠ entry to dummy you can discard the ♦ and ♣.

You can see how it works if the trump suit DID split 3-2 as you would expect it to do. Even without a trump loser you will still go down 1 if you cannot take two discards on dummy's ♥s.

So you give up a trump trick and gain two ♥ tricks in return. What a deal.

South is to play 6 ♠. West leads the ♦ Q.

Losers: ♠ = 0 or 1 ♥ = 0 ♦ = 1 ♣ = 1 Total = 2 or 3

You probably do not have a trump loser because they will probably split 3-2. Still, a 4-1 split is certainly not out of the question.

But those two minor suit losers are definite **UNLESS** you can somehow get to dummy's ♥ K Q. Can you?

You win the ♦ A.

Everyone follows.

East wins the ♠ J.

Yes you can get to dummy, in the trump suit. Win the opening ♦ lead. Unblock the ♥ A before touching trumps. Play a **SMALL** trump toward

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 9

♥ A J 9

♦ 6

♣ A K Q J 9 8 7

♠ J 10 8 6 3

♥ Q 8 7

♦ A Q 10 5

♣ 4



♠ A Q

♥ 6 4 3

♦ 8 7 4 2

♣ 6 5 3 2

♠ 7 5 4 2

♥ K 10 5 2

♦ K J 9 3

♣ 10

West

1 ♣

3 ♣

5 ♣

All Pass

5 ♣ by West

Lead: ♠ J

North

Pass

Pass

East

1NT

4 ♣

South

Pass

Pass

West is to play 5 ♣. North leads the ♠ J; dummy wins with the ♠ Q, South plays the ♠ 2 and you the ♠ 9.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=0 Total = 3

You have no way to get rid of the Fast ♦ loser, but you might be able to eliminate one of the ♥ losers. If South holds either ♥ K 10 x or ♥ Q 10 x then a Deep Finesse would save one loser.

Should you pull trumps right away?

South plays low.

No, you cannot pull trumps yet. For the Deep Finesse to work you must lead twice from dummy. The only way to get into dummy twice is in the ♠ suit and one of those times must be at trick 1.

Win the first trick with dummy's ♠ Q and play a ♥ to your ♥ 9. Assume North wins with the ♥ K or ♥ Q, and plays another ♠.

In dummy for the last time, play a ♥ to your ♥ J and hope it wins.

As you can see, you must play ♥s twice from dummy in order to take the two finesses.

So you couldn't pull that one round of trumps because you couldn't waste either visit to dummy for anything other than the ♥ finesses.